

(460) Visual Design Team

Description & Eligibility

Create a new branding package for the provided topic. Any postsecondary or secondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. **Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines will be disqualified.**

Topic

Paws in the Park – Community Pet Adoption Festival Scenario: Your team has been hired to design promotional components for a local pet adoption event called *Paws in the Park – Find a Friend, Change a Life*.

Deliverables:

- Logo design for the event
- At least three (3) promotional items, such as:
 - Event poster/banner
 - Social media ads (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok)
 - Event T-shirt for volunteers
 - Adoption certificate template
 - Pet-themed swag (stickers, buttons, or reusable tote bags)
- Event Info:
 - Location: Willow Creek Park, Nashville, TN
 - Date: Saturday, September 14, 2026
 - Time: 9 a.m. – 4 p.m.

Team Must Supply

- Optional - Digital presentation tools and supporting equipment (device, software, projector, extension cords, etc.)
- Optional - Props

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged.
- Carry-in and set-up of equipment must be done solely by the team within the time allotted.
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, contestants may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges.
- No materials may be left with the judges.
- Only the team captain should complete the submission.
- Length of event – no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Finals may be part of the competition.
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries.

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
The following items have been saved as PDFs and bundled together in a single ZIP file. 1. Logo (JPG, PNG, or PDF) 2. The other three (3) promotional items (JPG, PNG, MP4 or PDF) 3. Works Cited 4. BPA Release Form(s)	VDT-TeamID.zip	April 1, 2025, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

- Demonstrate effective use of color, lines, text, graphics, shapes, etc.
- Demonstrate the ability to present ideas to prospective customers illustrating reasoning and logic for the theme
- Apply principles of design, layout, and typography
- Use appropriate artwork and design techniques to effectively illustrate a theme
- Apply technical skills to manipulate graphics, artwork, and image
- Demonstrate an understanding of developing for a specific target audience
- Demonstrate teamwork skills needed to function effectively

Contest Specifications for this Event

- All graphics must be computer generated
- It is recommended designs be at least 300 dpi

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit the URL to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2026.
- Upload completed projects to a video/file sharing link (Vimeo, YouTube, Dropbox, etc.). Projects must be viewable on Windows and Mac platforms. Set the access level of your project to one of BPA's recommended settings. See the Cloud Sharing Guidelines for additional information. An auto-generated confirmation will be provided upon project submission for the National Leadership Conference; individual confirmation cannot be provided. **No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.**
- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

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Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
The following items have been saved as PDFs and bundled together in a single ZIP file. 1. Logo (JPG, PNG, or PDF) 2. The other three (3) promotional items (JPG, PNG, MP4 or PDF) 3. Works Cited (formatted in accordance with the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i>) 4. BPA Release Form(s)				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-17 points	Meets Expectations 18-35 points	Above Expectations 35-50 points	Points Awarded
Audience Awareness	Design choices ignore or conflict with audience needs.	Design makes appropriate decisions for intended audience.	Design shows deep understanding of audience with highly effective visual strategies.	/50
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-20 points	Above Expectations 21-30 points	Points Awarded
Creativity and Originality	Ideas lack originality or rely heavily on generic concepts.	Products show some imaginative and creative thinking.	Products showcase bold, original ideas and inventive execution.	/30
Visual Impact	Visuals are dull, cluttered, or confusing.	Design is visually appealing and captures attention.	Design is visually captivating with strong use of aesthetic principles.	/30
Consistency Across Products	Products appear disconnected or overly similar.	Designs relate well while maintaining distinct identity.	Designs show consistent branding with individualized, creative variation.	/30
Clear Focal Point	Focal point is missing or unclear.	Each product has a clear and intentional center of interest.	All products feature compelling focal points that enhance viewer engagement.	/30
Balanced Composition	Layout feels chaotic or lacks unity.	Designs are balanced and unified with thoughtful structure.	Composition demonstrates elegant harmony, creating a polished and professional feel.	/30
Color & Font Use	Font and color choices clash or distract from message.	Fonts and colors are appropriate and enhance the design.	Fonts and color palettes are expertly chosen to elevate overall impact.	/30
Whitespace Usage	Design feels overcrowded or sparsely laid out.	Whitespace is used effectively to support visual clarity.	Whitespace is strategically used to enhance flow, hierarchy, and aesthetic value.	/30

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Con't)

Design Layout & Emphasis	Elements are randomly placed or lack emphasis.	Layout follows basic design principles with clear visual focus.	Strategic placement and emphasis guide viewer through the design, using advanced compositional techniques.	/30
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/300

(460) Visual Design Team
Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-15 points	Meets Expectations 16-30 points	Above Expectations 31-45 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/45
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES